

MALVALES

The ten families in the Malvales include many shrubs and trees, found mainly in tropical and warm temperate regions, but extending into cooler parts. The main members are the rockrose family (Cistaceae), mostly shrubs from the northern hemisphere; the more widespread mallow family (Malvaceae) of herbs, shrubs, and massive trees; and the pantropical Dipterocarpaceae, which includes some of the most important tropical timber trees.

COMMON ROCKROSE
Helianthemum nummularium
 F: Cistaceae

Found on sunny banks throughout most of Europe, this low shrub prefers lime-rich soils. Different subspecies grow in Europe's mountains.



50 cm
20 in



1 m/3¼ ft

HAIRY ROCKROSE
Cistus incanus
 F: Cistaceae

Several scientific names have been given to this widespread Mediterranean shrub, because its leaves vary greatly in hairiness and size.

CALIFORNIAN FLANNELBUSH
Fremontodendron californicum
 F: Malvaceae

The flowers of this spreading shrub produce showy masses in early summer. It lives high up in the granite mountains of California.



4 m/13 ft



10 m/33 ft

ANNATTO
Bixa orellana
 F: Bixaceae

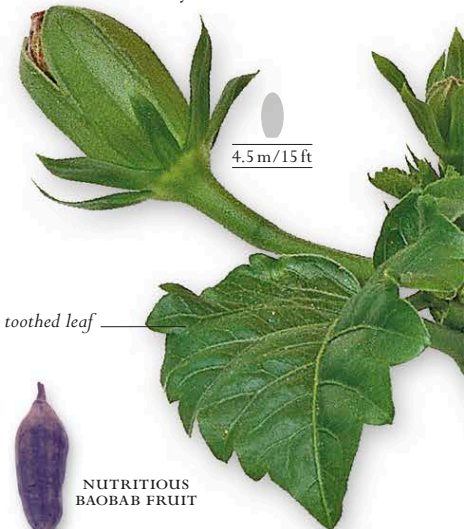
The food dye annatto comes from the spiny fruits of this pink-flowered shrub or small tree, native to tropical America.



five-petalled
rose-red flower

CHINESE HIBISCUS
Hibiscus rosa-sinensis
 F: Malvaceae

Possibly native to India, despite its name, this tropical shrub is one of several *Hibiscus* species cultivated for their showy blossoms.



4.5 m/15 ft

**NUTRITIOUS
BAOBAB FRUIT**

MATURE TREE


BAOBAB TREE
Adansonia digitata
 F: Malvaceae

This massive African tree is called an upside-down tree because, when leafless, its branches look like roots. It can live for 1,500 years.



FLOWERING
SPRIG

2 m/6½ ft

strongly
scented
flowers



FRUITING
STEM

MEZEREON
Daphne mezereum
 F: Thymelaeaceae

Damp woods and shady gorges are the typical habitat of this deciduous shrub, which is found across most of Europe.



80 cm
32 in

MUSK MALLOW
Malva moschata
 F: Malvaceae

Native to N. Africa and S. Europe, and a garden plant further north, this tall perennial grows in grassy and bushy places.



RIBBED
POD

12 m
40 ft

COCOA
Theobroma cacao
 F: Malvaceae

Originally from Brazilian rainforests, this tree is cultivated around the tropics. Cocoa comes from the seeds, known as beans, inside its fruit pods.

CAFFEINE-
CONTAINING
SEED



25 m/82 ft



GLOSSY OVAL
LEAVES

COLA NUT TREE
Cola nitida
 F: Malvaceae

The caffeine-rich seeds (called cola nuts) from the pods of this W. African tree are chewed for their stimulant effects.